



CHAPTER XX

CEDAR CITY IN THE 1870'S AND IRON WORKS AT IRON MOUNTAIN

The women of Cedar City held a mass meeting on February 1, 1870, to protest against the passage of the "Cullom Bill." The bill proposed by Representative Cullom of Illinois would, among other things, declare "cohabitation" a misdemeanor. In the eyes of people outside of the L.D.S. Church polygamy was considered to be cohabitation, as they did not recognize the legality of marriage to more than one wife. Mary Ann Lunt was a member of a committee which was selected to draft a resolution to protest against this bill which was before Congress. Mrs. Isaac C. Haight addressed the group and said, "If the Cullom Bill is permitted to pass, our husbands, fathers, and sons will be deprived of their liberty, both religiously and politically." She thought it was high time for the sisters to arise and do something in defense of their religion and not leave it all for the brethren to do. Ellen Lunt delivered the following speech:

It is with peculiar feelings, my dear sisters, that I meet with you on this present occasion. It is near twenty years since I joined the church, eighteen of which I have been identified with the Saints in this

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place, during which time I have never felt to turn back or regret the step I have taken. Since this Church was organized, relentless persecution has followed the Saints. The present 'Cullom's Bill' brings a passage of scripture forcibly to my mind which is: 'offenses must come, but woe to them by whom they come.' I have been in the Patriarchal order, as you all know, for a number of years and am happy to be the wife of one who is counted worthy of having a plurality of wives. I pray that we may remain steadfast to the principles of eternal truth revealed from heaven in the latter days.

Sister Caroline E. Arthur expressed that the "Cullom Bill" aimed at destroying the peace and tranquility of the family and homes and was an infringement of their rights and privileges as American citizens and in direct violation of the constitution of the country bequeathed to them by their forefathers. She said, "Shall we sit still and see the rights of our husbands, sons, and fathers wrested from them and be subject to fines and imprisonment while we are left to the protection of the 'Cullom' kind?" Several other women addressed the group. Mrs. W. E. Webster said, "What do you think of the 'Cullom Bill' that has 30 sections of laws in it in which he [Cullom] is pleading with Congress to pass in order to put our husbands and sons in bondage and, inasmuch as they are, we are also?" She also said, "Mr. C. must bare in mind he will have to build very large prisons to hold all of us, for we will not be separated."

Mrs. Mary Ann Lunt voiced the following thoughts to the congregation:

Beloved Sisters, I am glad of the privilege of being one with you today. We have met to show our indignation toward the 'Cullom Bill.' We have not been coerced or driven to take this step, for we are not the slaves that the originator of the Bill represents us. We have happy and comfortable homes surrounded with peace and plenty, beloved by our husbands,

honored and revered by our children, exalted above all other women. Is this a state of slavery? If so, it is a very pleasant one. We have many privileges guaranteed unto us, one of which is the right to choose our husbands and, amongst the many women in Utah, there are none that would want to marry either Father or Grandfather. We want no sympathy from friends abroad. We are content with our lot, for we chose it ourselves. Celestial marriage is sacred to us and, by the blessing of God, we will uphold and practice the same. Sisters, let us be helpmates in every deed, and use our utmost endeavors to oppose any measures that are, or may be taken, to deprive our husbands, sons and brothers of their hard-earned rights and privileges. That the blessings of the Lord may be with us continually is my prayer.¹

Sister Annabella Haight delivered a lengthy and impressive address to the audience and protested in strong terms against such members of Congress as would fain bring unjust and tyrannical abuses on this people. Others also voiced their opinions before they selected a committee which drafted a resolution to Congress. Whether this resolution had anything to do with the outcome of the Bill is not known, but they were thankful when the Bill failed in the Senate.²

Henry in his position as Bishop was involved with the Relief Society along with other organizations in the church, as well as the working out of domestic problems. In the late 1860's his good friend, John D. Lee, recorded in his diary that Bishop Lunt asked him to sit in on a Bishop's Court trying George Wood. Lee wrote:

Brother Wood had been through a period of irascible conduct which brought him before the court for discipline. He had, within a week, not only interrupted two public meetings but fought with two men, threatening to knock down Elder Palmer and beat one's brains out and to 'shake' J. P. Jones. Elder

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John Macfarlane, who had been reprov'd for volunteering to put Wood out of a public meeting, felt considerably rasped. After the trial he went to Bishop Lunt's, and I [Lee] was sent for where I reasoned the rest of the night with him, finally convincing him of his error. The former embraced me in his arms and said that I was like a father, and he much respected my counsel. While I was endeavoring to do right, or rather good, one of my lines was taken off my horses.

Henry was concerned about his close associate, John D. Lee. They had been friends for twenty years. The "Feds" were convinced of Lee's involvement in the Mountain Meadows Massacre, and many of the local people assumed he was guilty long before his first trial in July 1875. Whisperings about the massacre continued and the stories became more numerous and exaggerated. Lee's neighbors displayed their disapproval by making snide remarks to his wives and children.

In the spring of 1866 Lee's two sons, Willard and Joseph, were called on missions, so he rounded up some cattle to drive to Salt Lake City to meet the expenses of their transportation and clothes. Lee carried a letter from Bishop Henry Lunt to the effect that "Brother J. D. Lee is a staunch, firm Latter-day Saint, seeks to build up the Kingdom of God and live by its principles and is in full faith and fellowship" This was an important document for him to present wherever he stopped to do business.

On May 12, 1870, the *Deseret News* published the following article about Henry, who had been in Salt Lake City for April Conference:

CEDAR CITY--We had a visit yesterday from Bishop Henry Lunt of Cedar City, who came to this city to attend Conference. His report of affairs in that region is very encouraging. The settlers of Cedar City have had difficulties to contend with such as probably the people of no other place in the Territory have had to meet. There are several reasons for this, which we

need not enumerate here, but Bishop Lunt's own experience is illustrative of these difficulties--he has built five houses since he went there in 1851, the frequent change of location [of the city] and other causes requiring him to do so. But, it is hoped that these obstacles to progression are now overcome and that a career of prosperity has been entered upon by the people there, which will result in their city becoming the equal in beauty and wealth of any other city in the Territory which possesses no greater facilities. The failure to manufacture iron discouraged very many who once lived in Cedar, and they left in various directions. Other causes also prompted many to leave, and the majority of those who remained were persons who had no teams to take them away and were, perforce, compelled by their poverty to stay. They had to turn their attention to agriculture, the attempt to manufacture iron having previously occupied all their time. Being so destitute of stock, their progress was necessarily slow, but they persevered and now they begin to reap the reward of their diligence.

There are about seventy families in the settlement and they own a flock of two thousand head of sheep, said by good judges to be one of the very best in the Territory; they have a good supply also of horned stock which they herd on the cooperative principle. They have opened the road up the canyon to the timber which is very good, and hope soon to be able to get a steam sawmill which will furnish lumber, a material that has been wanted in the past. They have increased the area of their farming land by fencing, and they now have more and better land under cultivation than they have ever had. The average yield of wheat to the acre for the entire settlement has greatly increased within the past ten years.

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Altogether, Cedar City seems to be a thrifty settlement and a good place for men to go who wish to get a start. Bishop Lunt informs us that they desire more population, and they are willing to give settlers land to cultivate and water to irrigate it. They lack men of capital, but they, themselves, are hardworking men whose only capital is their labor, and they know how to appreciate that class, if any should come among them. We think that very many who remain in this city, and depend upon employment for the means to sustain themselves, might settle at such a place as Cedar City with advantage. By industry and good management they could, in a few years, lay the foundation of comparative independence. Bishop Lunt started today for Cedar City.

The party that traveled with Henry to Conference stayed at Cove Fort on the way to and from Salt Lake City. The distance between Beaver and Kanosh afforded the Indians an excellent opportunity to attack travelers and make good their escape. Cove Fort provided the much-needed protection for travelers going by what was called the "Southern Route" to and from California. It stood not far from the canyon which ran over the pass into Sevier Valley. Wilford Woodruff wrote the following description of Cove Fort in his journal:

This Fort is a very substantial building. I think it is the best in the Territory. It is built of volcanic rock, laid in with mortar. Each of the four walls is one-hundred feet long on the outside and eighteen feet high from the foundation. On the east side is a gateway, fourteen feet wide, six feet deep and three inches thick, set inside with a substantial arch. Above this, preparations are being made for a lookout and telegraph office. On the west side is a gateway eight by four feet with projections inside ten and one-half feet wide and ten feet high. The front contains twelve

rooms, six on the north and six on the south side, ten of which are sixteen by fourteen feet. Two are sixteen by seventeen feet, and nine feet four inches high. There is a chimney to each room three feet wide and two feet thick, which rises six feet above the top of the wall. The roof is covered with good shaved pine shingles. The entire building contains 2,250 perch of rock, 1,975 bushels of lime, and has cost, to the present, \$22,690.³

While Henry was in Salt Lake City for Conference, he went to the doctor for treatment of his eyes. They had bothered him for some time, possibly as a result of an infection or snow blindness. One account said, "he took cold in his eyes on the way to Salt Lake and spent hundreds of dollars, being under a doctor's care for months. The treatment was so severe that it burned his eyes and nothing could be done to restore his sight." He lost his sight for several months and, although he recuperated to some extent, he remained partially blind for the rest of his life.⁴

On July 4, 1870, the Census lists the Lunt family of Cedar City, Utah as follows (Apparently there were three locations):

Location 2.2	Lunt, Henry (Farmer)	age 45
	Ellen (Milliner)	age 40
Location 3.3	Lunt, Ann (Housekeeper)	age 27
	Jane	age 6
	Jemima	age 4
	Roselia	age 2
	One male laborer	No age given
Location 5.5	Lunt, Mary Ann (Housekeeper)	age 36
	Henrietta	age 11
	Ellen	age 9
	Henry W.	age 7
	Randle	age 5
	William	age 3
	Florence	age 5 mo.
	Rice, Charles (Laborer)	age 20 ⁵

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The Relief Society met August 25, 1870 in the Social Hall to sew carpet rags, etc. The following donations were received: Rachel Whittaker, 2 lbs. rolls (wool yarn) and 25 cents legal tender; Ellen and Mary Ann Lunt, 25 cents each legal tender; Sarah Chatterley, 25 cents legal tender; Ellen Nelson, 1 dozen eggs and 15 cents and 10 cents legal tender; Jane Birkbeck, ½ pound butter; Christina Chatterley, 1 pound rolls; Caroline Jenson, ½ dozen eggs; Mary A. Unthank, 1 dozen eggs; Hannah Christopherson, 1 pound wool; Sarah Chatterley, 2 1/4 pounds rolls. Received from Sarah Chatterley for wool being picked, 25 cents. Margaret Mackelprang, 1 pound rolls. The following young sisters formed themselves into a "Spinning Bee" and spun 14 pounds of rolls amounting to a \$7.00 value: Ann Wood, Elizabeth L. Parry, Mary Ann Leigh, Sarah J. Leigh, Josephine Chatterley, Rachel M. Corry, Ella Birkbeck, Annie Mackelprang, Elizabeth Hunter, Priscilla Smith, Teressa Urie, Ann Elizabeth Perry, Alice Jane Perry, Henrietta Lunt and Elizabeth Adams.

Ann Gower Lunt had her fourth child on October 6, 1870, in Cedar City. She and Henry decided to name him Oscar Gower Lunt.

John Urie of Cedar City wrote the following article which appeared in the *Deseret News* January 17, 1871:

Editor, *Deseret News*: A local conference was held at this place last Sunday. President Dame with Elders Jesse N. Smith and Pendleton of Parowan were present. We had a refreshing time, many things being spoken that were of an encouraging nature. Bishop Lunt, although severely afflicted with sore eyes for the past nine months, was particularly noticeable. The authorities of the Church, general and local, were presented and, of course, accepted without a dissenting voice. Our spiritual condition was considered healthy by our teachers.

Without indulging in any speeches of praise that might be awarded to the Saints of this place, I will state that 'By their fruits they shall be known.' One hundred and twenty children attend daily our common

schools. Our Cooperative store paid thirty-one per cent on a capital stock of \$4000, one thousand of this being invested in a threshing machine. Our Sheep Cooperative herd brought, all things considered, about \$450, and we are indulging in the belief that we have the best sheep flock in southern Utah. Our Cattle Cooperative Institution is but young, but our hope in this venture is good. We have also subscribed stock to the amount of \$3,500 in the Rio Virgin Manufacturing Company, considerable of which is paid. Many houses of a substantial character have been built during last year. Vigorous measures are also being taken for the erection of a rock meeting house. Our crops last year were excellent, a boon for which we thank the Giver of all good. The winter has been severe, the cold intense--the thermometer being as low as six degrees below zero. Snow is plentiful--sleighing, dancing and making merry are, at present, the order of the day.

Ground was broken for a new meeting house or tabernacle in Cedar City on February 6, 1871. The ground was dedicated by Edward Stevenson, but actual work on the building was not started until some time later.

The Rio Virgin Mfg. Company spoken of was instigated by Brigham Young who promised the settlers, if they could raise enough cotton, wool and other raw materials, they could enter into a cooperative association and have the church's cotton factory, allowing them an interest as stockholders. Such an association was formed in April 1870 with Apostle Erastus Snow as president. The members of the board of directors were prominent ecclesiastical leaders in the southern settlements. This association later incorporated and signed notes on \$40,000 worth of cotton and woolen machinery which bore an annual rate of interest of 10 per cent. Shortly after the association had been organized, the woolen machinery was freighted to Washington, Utah. In addition, new machinery was purchased which resulted in the plant having the capacity to produce 550 yards of cloth

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per day. All of the money for this machinery was raised locally. The end product of the factory was sold through cooperative stores in southern Utah, and to Z.C.M.I. in Salt Lake City. The factory operated until 1910.⁶

The following letter written by Henry Lunt appeared in the *Deseret News* January 28, 1871. The article was entitled, "Iron Company to Make Iron." It was also printed in *The Milennial Star*:

The Deseret Telegraph Line is in fine working order, and a railroad to Colorado from Salt Lake City is in contemplation. Thus the lightening serves the Lord and a highway is cast up for his Saints. The Iron Company at Iron City is preparing to make iron at an early date [Iron City was located southwest of Iron Mountain, about 30 miles from Cedar City].

When the Deseret Telegraph line was built in 1867, Henry's first wife, Ellen, was one of the first operators and was in charge of the telegraph office in the Tithing Office. Later the telegraph was moved into the Lunt home, which was known as the Lunt Hotel and Stage Stop. It remained there until Bell Telephone Company installed telephones in Cedar City and took over the telegraph in 1903.

On April 17, 1871, the Bishop of the Pinto Ward, Richard R. Robinson, wrote the following letter which was published in the *Deseret News*:

On Friday, April 14, I visited the Iron Works in our ward and saw the brethren actually making iron. After three years of hard struggle, success has actually crowned their efforts. I saw several tons stacked by the Works and they were tapping the furnace at regular intervals and running out some eight hundred pounds every eight hours. No interruptions or stoppages by non-fluxing or chilling or uncontrollable obstructions occur, as perplexed the brethren at Cedar City years ago, but everything seems to work very

satisfactorily. Brother Richard Harrison of this place was present, a man of long experience in molding iron in England, and he pronounced the iron No. 1. Their blast is blown by a small steam engine imported from the east at considerable cost. The members of the company, few in number, labored hard and long to bring about the present result. There are some dozen or fifteen hands at work running night and day, and when the material on the ground is used up, they will be compelled to stop and blow out the furnace, not having hands or capital enough to keep it running and supply it at the same time.

The company is making arrangements to cast the iron into useful articles such as hand irons, sad irons, hollow ware and stoves, and show the people in Utah and the world that the manufacture of iron in Utah is a fact. As I said, the few that stuck to the enterprise have labored hard and have become somewhat reduced in circumstances, but as success has attended their efforts, they are quite elated in their feelings at the prospects of the future. The company is organized in the cooperative principle with Brother Ebenezer Hanks as President, who is quite a business man. Brother Homer Duncan is Vice President, with good men for directors. Brother Seth M. Blair is Secretary.

The Iron Company had the hope that there would be a new market for iron in building railroads. The Transcontinental Railroad had been completed with the uniting at Promontory near Ogden, Utah, on May 10, 1869. This meant there would be future expansion of the rail system. However, the 300 miles to market from Iron City to Salt Lake City became the major deterrent.

One of the meetings of the Cedar City Relief Society took place on July 27, 1871. They met in the afternoon in the Social Hall. President Annabella Haight called the meeting to order and Counselor Rachel Whittaker conducted the business. She requested that all the

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sisters who had the legal right to vote come to the polls on election day and exercise the right of female suffrage. Mary Ann Lunt, along with several other members, expressed a desire to carry out the instructions they had that day received in regard to female suffrage.

President Brigham Young and several others left Salt Lake City on October 24, 1871. Their destination was St. George where he was to dedicate a temple site there on November 9. The group stopped in Cedar City on the way and stayed at the Lunt Hotel. Elizabeth Wood Cane, a writer, who was with the group, wrote the following about the Lunt family and Cedar City:

When we fairly entered Cedar City I was pleased with its many long rows of trees. It is a comparatively old town, and they have had time to attain a very large size. The street where we halted was a shady avenue, and the lids drooped of my homesick Evan's eyes as the breeze rustled in the leafless branches arching overhead [Evan was her son].

Underfoot was a sheet of ice. The person whose duty it was to shut off the water at night that flowed through the streets had forgotten to do so the night before, and the channels had frozen on the surface and overflowed and frozen again. We drew up before a large brick house in front of which a great bell swung [from a belfry on top]. It had been made at the foundry, and when I suggested to our hostess that the noise it made must be deafening so close to the parlor window, she answered with simplicity, 'Oh no, there's such a crack in it that it makes hardly any noise at all.'

Our host was a blind man, hardly in the prime of life [age 47], the terrible disease of the eyes which is so prevalent in southern Utah had fallen upon him and all the afflictions of Job, in the way of losses of cattle and other property, seemed to have followed. He would have been absolutely helpless but for the exertions of his two brave wives, little hens that

scratched the barnyard faithfully for the support of the brood. They turned the house into an inn and, though it was but sparsely furnished, it was spotlessly clean as I know, for I sat part of the afternoon in the kitchen. The wife who was busiest there had no children of her own, though one of the other wife's [children] had been given to and reared by her, and she had the neat kitchen strangely furnished. One end was carpeted with oilcloth, and in front of a window, full of scarlet geraniums, stood a table with a brightly polished telegraph apparatus; and, she turned from her stove and its pots and pans to her battery and clicking needlepoint without flurry or embarrassment. I asked her whether it had been hard for her to learn, for she was no longer young. She said, 'Yes', that her fingers were inflexible, and that it had been very hard to eyes unused to delicate sewing and ears unpracticed to listen to fine differences of sound, but the Lord had helped her, knowing Mr. Hunt's [Lunt] need. She spoke of herself as a rough and uneducated woman, though I found she had an accurate ear for music and a lovely voice in singing. But, she had mastered her profession well enough to tell by ear what was going over the wires, and I believe that it is considered a tolerable test.

I like to see women telegraphing, it is dainty work well suited to our sex; and, on our Eastern roads, the officers tell me that the women telegraphers are more steadily attentive to their duties than men and, of course, seldomer, I hope I may say, never stupefied with the fumes of tobacco or liquor. Their offices are cleaner too, and gay with flowers, and those who, for their sins, are compelled to wait for a train at a wayside station often appreciate this difference. Still, women yield to one dissipation men are less apt to indulge in, and it was a characteristic that betrayed the

sex of the telegrapher at the place we had left in the morning, when Mrs. Lunt remarked to her sister-wife that 'Parowan has been called by St. George three times without answering. *She will go to meeting!*'

Mr. Lunt did what he could to help, poor fellow, and poked his way about with a long stick as he directed his little boys in the barn and garden. They had a garden behind the house which must have been very pretty in summer, the large beds having neat box edges, and the main walk passing between fine peach trees. His voice and manner, though melancholic and subdued, were those of a gentleman, and, sitting apart beside the fire, I overheard what was probably not intended for my ears. His little unkept barefooted boys had followed him into the room. He sat down with my Evan on his knee and, passing his hand over the child's curling locks and the fine cloth of his jacket, said to his own sons, 'Lads, when I was your age I was dressed like this and a servant waited upon me. When you grow to my age, remember I never grudged what I have undergone for my faith.'

In the morning, when we assembled for prayers, he was prayed for, Mormon fashion, 'Bless his lids that the swelling may diminish; and his eyeballs that the inflammation may cease; and the nerve of his eyes that its sensitiveness may be restored and that he may see again the beauty and the glory of Thy Kingdom.' After we rose, as the custom was in many houses, the family sang a hymn, and it touched me to see him (although there were *two* wives which present repelled me), standing with his hand on the shoulder of one, the telegraph operator [Ellen], while the other had her little ones grouped about her, and singing, 'Mercy, oh thou Son of David, Thus blind Bartimeus prayed.'

Poor man! His eyesight, I heard, did get a little better before we left Utah, and he became able to 'see

men as trees walking,' and for even that cloudy vision he was thankful. As he said after prayers that day, 'It might be the Lord's will to grant him sight, and if so his faith should not be wanting to enable him to lay hold of the blessing.'

While I was acquainting myself with this simple household, Brigham Young was pestered in the parlor by some of the same class of mining speculators who beset him at Salt Lake City. There were also plain farmers who had come to seek counsel of 'Brother Brigham,' whether to sell their farms to speculators, or to go shares with them in seeking minerals, or simply to plod on, using their coal only for family purposes. These gaped with open mouths at the glib, eager man, who had his pocket full of specimens from this and that neighboring mountain, and who pressed upon Brigham Young a share in his enterprise in return for a loan of the capital his worn boots showed his need of. These men had some really fine specimens, though their value was impaired to experienced eyes by their having been 'doctored.' Still, I do not mean to say that Cedar City has not a great future before it, possessing as it does, coal, lime, and iron ores in convenient proximity to each other. I hope Mr. Lunt's boys may share the prosperity of their birthplace!

Brigham Young presently made his escape to a more interesting group. Outside the windows near the big bell stood, all the winter afternoon, a patient cluster of Indians. One sat on a rough pony, who stood motionless with drooping head, tired apparently by a long journey. The rider had his foot in a bloody bandage and glanced from time to time at the parlor window. Did he hope the Great Medicine, 'Brigham', would come out and cure him? He never said anything and rode quietly away at dusk. I knew 'Brigham' couldn't cure him, but felt half-provoked

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that he didn't come out and make-believe to do so. The leader, a well-built and, for a Ute, rather handsome man, could speak a few words of Mexican-Spanish. He bore a name common to many chiefs in Utah, but not then known to fame. He was a, but not the Captain John, Juan, or Jack. I transfer this mention of him from my notebook here, solely because I have a story to tell of him, further on. He became possessed with the notion that he was divinely inspired, and did some frightfully queer things. I have seen something of insane persons, and a good deal more of religious enthusiasts; but a red Indian crazy upon religion is the hardest character to understand I can conceive of. The belief of some of these characters in their most ridiculous fancies is absolute. One of them, for instance, who was recently an esteemed friend of this very John, ordered his followers to kill him to prove how instantly he would receive a new body. He laid his head down; they chopped it off, and I visited his grave.⁷ [Note: On Oct. 9, 1871, President Brigham Young was involved in a court case in Salt Lake City, Utah, referred to as 'The people versus Polygamy Theocracy.' Therefore, the writer referred to him as Mr. T. She also used the name 'Hunt' in place of Lunt].

At the time of this writing, Ellen was 42, Mary Ann was 38, and Ann Gower Lunt was 29 years old. The Lunts had a total of 1 children.

When the sisters of Cedar City met on December 14, 1871, Ellen Lunt gave a short account of her visit to Salt Lake City. She and her husband, Bishop Lunt, had stayed there for five months during the summer while Henry was having his eyes treated. Sister Haig expressed the feelings of all the sisters, after Bishop Lunt joined them in the meeting, when she said she was glad to see him home and "hoped he would soon again receive his sight." She advised them to

speak so the Bishop could judge their feelings. Henry gave a short discourse and he advised the sisters to use their influence with their husbands to keep their wheat and flour at home and not take it to the Gentiles. It was then unanimously decided that everyone donate something for the building of the temple in St. George.

During the meeting held by the sisters on March 14, 1872, several of the sisters donated fifty cents each for the temple, only one person gave a dollar, which amounted to a total of \$5.50. Many of the others donated cloth, yarn, wheat, flour, and even eggs. In addition to the cash, the sundries were valued at \$12.37, making a total of \$17.87.⁸

On March 26, 1872, a letter was sent by the Iron County Clerk to Robert L. Campbell in Salt Lake City as follows:

Dear Sir: The following show the returns of the census of this county so far as received:

Paragonah	220
Parowan	876
Summit	162
Johnson	56
Cedar City	500
Iron Springs	34
Hamilton Fort	57
Kanarra	242
Pinto	250
Iron City	60
Hebron	100
Antelope Springs	60
Desert Springs	16
Sulphur Springs	15
Panguitch	620
Johnson's Mill	25
Thompson's Mill	15
Sherwood's Mill	20
TOTAL	3,328

This certifies that the above census of Iron County is correct according to the best of my knowledge. Jesse N. Smith, County Clerk⁹

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A son, Richard Henry Lunt, was born to Ann Gower Lunt and Henry Lunt on Nov. 17, 1872. He died the same day.

Most communities had a cooperative sheep and cattle herd in which each person, and the church, turned their sheep or cattle over to the co-op herd in return for an equivalent number of shares in the association. The herd was managed by an elected set of directors and appointed managers, and profits were distributed according to the shares held. This worked very well for the settlers and the herd increased in quantity and quality with this type of management. In the 1860's the Cedar City Co-op and Livestock Company acquired some of the pasture land and meadow north and east of the Fort (Enoch).¹

On April 20, 1873, D. P. Clark, from Parowan, said that about every ten days a small herd of stock was being stolen from the range. There was no mistake about it, as the tracks were seen going toward the Nevada mining districts. The settlers decided that they had better gather up their own stock and put them in the cooperative herd, so a general cattle drive was arranged. By April 26 they had gathered the stock from all over the ranges, with the exception of their milk cows. Even those people who did not belong to the church turned their stock in with the cooperative herd. Much of the stealing of the livestock apparently was solved by this action.

Rabbits were a big problem for the farmers. There were so many that they destroyed a good part of the crops. It was necessary to control them to save the pasture and grain crops. On Thursday, May 20, 1873, a rabbit hunt was organized. A large number of men, women, and children turned out to hunt rabbits. They drove large numbers into the Little Salt Lake and killed about 2000. A similar hunt was repeated a week later with good results.¹¹

Violet Wilson Lunt was born on August 10, 1873. She was the daughter of Henry and Mary Ann Wilson Lunt.

President Brigham Young and his brother, Joseph A. Young, came through Parowan on the way to St. George where President Young owned a winter home. On April 10, 1874, they organized the United Order in Parowan which was the Iron County seat. President Young said, "We labor together for the building up of the Kingdom of God. This new order will not make men poorer, but will take thousands

and make them better off than ever they were before." William Durham was elected as President of the organization and Bishop Henry Lunt and Samuel Leigh were the two Directors from Cedar City. President Young was attempting to "sell" the United Order organization wherever he went. It was necessary to hold two shares in the organization in order to be one of the officers.¹²

Another child was born to Ann Gower Lunt and Henry Lunt on May 18, 1874. They named him George Albert Gower Lunt.

The success in making "pig iron" at Iron City brought on new interest in the iron properties. The following contract was drawn up at the house of Samuel Leigh at Iron Springs on June 26, 1874:

We the undersigned citizens of the United States desire and agree to and do hereby form a Mining District to be known and styled, 'Magnetic Mining District of Utah Territory,' at what is known as Iron Springs, Iron County, Utah Territory, between nine and ten miles northwesterly from Cedar City. Signed: Henry Lunt, Chapman Duncan, John M. Higbee, John C. Duncan, Ebenezer Hanks, Thomas Walker, Richard R. Birkbeck, Samuel Barnhurst, and John Harris.¹³

The following letter written by Henry Lunt to the *Deseret News* was published on October 17, 1874:

I have just received information from Ebenezer Hanks, Esq., Superintendent of the Great Western Iron Co., Iron City, per William Holyoak and John Eyre, who have just returned from that place, that the blast furnace is doing splendid business. The furnace is tapped every ten hours. The last run was twenty-five hundred pounds. They expect next week to make five tons of pig iron per day. They shipped two tons for Provo yesterday. Everybody here is rejoicing at the prospect of the development of the immense deposits of iron stone in this region.

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Another article was written in the *Deseret News* which contained information that when the iron ore from Iron City arrived in Provo it was examined and determined to be as good as "could be imported from any quarter. This iron could be hauled to the southern terminus of the railroad, freighted to and delivered in this city at a price that would compete with that of the article brought from Pittsburg." It was determined that the importance of developing the manufacture of iron in Utah could not be overestimated; in fact, it would result in public good in building up home manufactures and industries, and stop one of those impoverishing drains upon the territory, consisting of money paid out for imported articles that can as well be manufactured at home. Plans were being made to establish rolling mills for the purpose of manufacturing railroad iron. In addition to pieces of cast iron, such as stoves, for home use, they were producing mining machinery for sale in Nevada mining camps. Among other things, the company furnished the iron for the twelve life-sized iron oxen on which the baptismal font in the St. George Temple rests.¹⁴

The successful manufacturing of iron products was good news to the people of southern Utah. However, nothing seemed to compensate for the aftermath of the Mountain Meadows Massacre, which was still hindering the progress of the communities. In September 1874, the Grand Jury in the Second Judicial District filed indictments charging William H. Dame, Isaac C. Haight, John D. Lee, William C. Steward, John M. Higbee, George Adair, Eliot Wilder, Samuel Jewkes and Philip K. Smith with participation in the Mountain Meadows Massacre. All, except Lee and Dame, were released from custody. In the case of William H. Dame, the President of the Parowan Stake, he was arrested in November of 1874 and, due to the bitterness of the times, was held in prison for two years while the prosecution was trying to find evidence to implicate him. He was trying to get a trial date set during that time, but his demands were flaunted and the judge refused to let him out on bail. His persecutors said that they would keep him in jail until they could find enough evidence to convict him.¹⁵

While President Dame was forced to stay in prison, his Counselors, Smith and Rogers, carried on the business of the Church. During this

time Henry Lunt was set apart by George A. Smith on December 19, 1874, as the Patriarch of the Parowan Stake. He also continued to hold the position of Bishop of the Cedar Ward.¹⁶

1. Ellen W. Lunt, Secretary, "Relief Society Minute Book 'A'," Entry for February 1, 1870, L. D. S. Church Library, Salt Lake City, Utah.
2. Leonard J. Arrington, *Great Basin Kingdom*, (Lincoln Nebraska: University of Nebraska Press, 1958), page 357.
3. Matthias F. Cowley, *Wilford Woodruff*, (Salt Lake City, Utah: Bookcraft 1964), Page 459.
4. Vern and Rachel Petty Lunt, *Life of Henry Lunt*, (Salt Lake City, Utah: 1944), p. 72.
5. United States Census, 1870, S.U.U. Special Collections Library, Cedar City, Utah.
6. Leonard J. Arrington, *op. cit.*, p. 319.
7. Elizabeth Wood Kane, *Twelve Mormon Homes*, (1871), S.U.U. Special Collections Library, Cedar City, Utah.
8. Ellen W. Lunt, Secretary, *op. cit.* Entry for March 14, 1872.
9. State of Utah Archives, Salt Lake City, Utah.
10. Phillip Hanks, *Parowan Stake History*, L. D. S. Institute, Cedar City, Utah, p. 41.
11. *Ibid.*, p. 41.
12. *Ibid.*, p. 10.
13. Iron County Assessor's History File, Entry for June 26, 1874, At Sec 20 T35S, R12W, Iron County Courthouse, Parowan, Utah.
14. Leonard J. Arrington, *op. cit.*, p. 316.
15. William R. Palmer, S.U.U. Special Collections Library, File F-31 Box 23, Cedar City, Utah.
16. *L. D.S. Biographical Encyclopedia*, "Henry Lunt," L.D.S. Institute, Cedar City, Utah.